

EXPERIMENT 09

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

To explore AI-assisted features and built-in analytics using Zia in Zoho Creator by analyzing hotel booking data, generating useful insights, creating visualizations, and improving the application dashboard to support better decision-making.

Objectives

- To review the application dashboard's auto-generated summary tiles and charts (Distribution by Priority Level, Distribution by Created By).
- To study how conditional formatting highlights Priority Level and Status values with colour so patterns are visible at a glance.
- To study Kanban report views (Priority Levels, Departments) as a built-in way to group and visualise records without any scripting.
- To review the All Department Masters and All Appointment Records list reports as the structured data these analytics are built on.
- To understand Zia's role within Zoho Creator in suggesting chart types, generating dashboard layouts, and surfacing patterns in application data.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Access/Live mode

Introduction / Theory

Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator ships with analytics components that turn form records into visual summaries without any separate BI tool. A Dashboard page can combine summary tiles, pie and bar charts, and embedded reports in one view; individual reports can use conditional formatting to colour rows or cells by field value; and a Kanban report groups

records into columns by a chosen field, giving a board-style view of status or priority. All of these read live data directly from the application's forms, so the visuals update automatically as records are added or changed.

Zia - Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, including Creator. Within Creator, Zia-driven features assist application builders by suggesting appropriate chart types for a given report, helping auto-generate dashboard layouts from existing forms, and surfacing trends (such as which priority level or status occurs most often) that would otherwise need manual analysis. Rather than requiring the developer to hand-code every chart, Zia-assisted suggestions speed up the process of turning a plain data table into a meaningful visual summary.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page combining summary tiles, charts, and embedded reports into a single, auto-refreshing overview of application data.
Chart Widget	A visual element (pie, bar, donut, etc.) bound to a report that summarises records by a chosen field, such as Priority Level or Created By.
Conditional Formatting	A report-level rule that colours a cell or row automatically based on its value, making outliers (e.g. Urgent priority, Cancelled status) stand out without manual review.

Kanban Report	A board-style report that groups records into columns by a selected field (e.g. Priority Level, Department), letting staff drag and scan records visually.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions within Zoho Creator that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts, and highlight patterns in the underlying data.

Application Specifications

Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Patient Appointment Scheduling System
Primary Forms	Patient Profile, Appointment Record, Department Master, Patient Department Link
Dashboard Elements	Total Patient Department Links, Total Appointment Records, Total Department Masters, Total Patient Profiles tiles; Distribution by Priority Level pie chart; Review Status tiles; Distribution by Created By bar chart
Conditionally Formatted Reports	All Patient Department Links (coloured by Priority Level), All Appointment Records (coloured by Status)

Kanban Reports	Priority Levels (grouped by Priority Level: High, Urgent, Low, Medium), Departments (grouped by Department under Patient Profiles)
Master Data Report	All Department Masters (Department Name, Code, Head of Department, Contact Email/Phone, Location, Is Active, Description)

Procedure

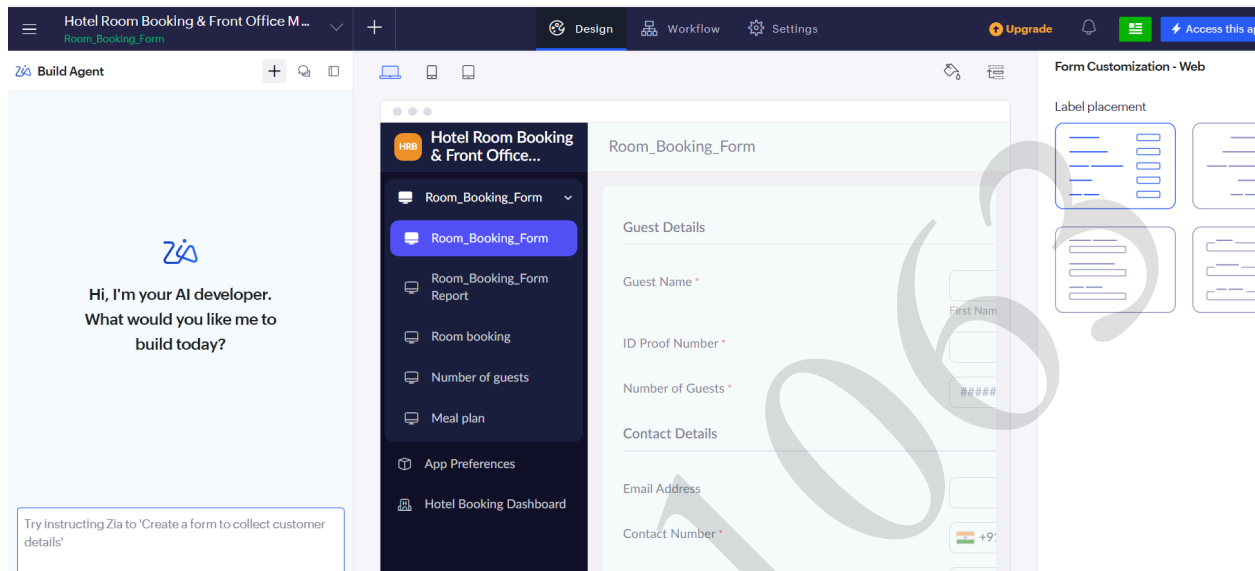
Step 1: Open the Application

The Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management application was opened in Zoho Creator.

The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator interface for the 'Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management' application. The main workspace shows the 'Room_Booking_Form' in design mode. The form is divided into two main sections: 'Guest Details' and 'Contact Details'. The 'Guest Details' section includes fields for 'First Name', 'Last Name', 'ID Proof Number', and 'Number of Guests'. The 'Contact Details' section includes fields for 'Email Address', 'Contact Number' (with a dropdown for country code and a pre-filled number), and 'Permanent Address' (with an 'Address Line 1' sub-field). A left sidebar provides navigation options, including 'Room_Booking_Form', 'Room_Booking_Form Report', 'Room booking', 'Number of guests', 'Meal plan', 'App Preferences', and 'Hotel Booking Dashboard'. A right sidebar titled 'Form Customization - Web' shows options for 'Label placement'. The bottom status bar indicates the app was created 11 days ago and includes links for 'Upgrade', 'Get started faster!', and 'Help'.

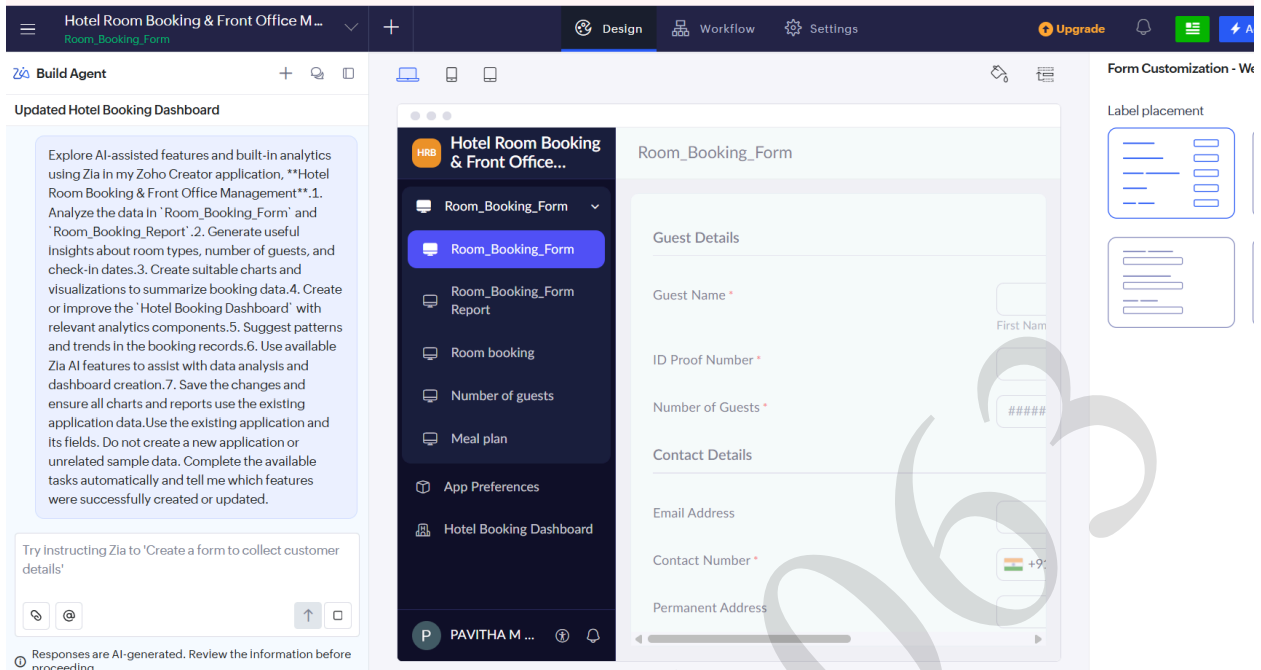
Step 2: Access Zia

The available Zia AI-assisted features were accessed to explore their capabilities for data analysis and dashboard creation.



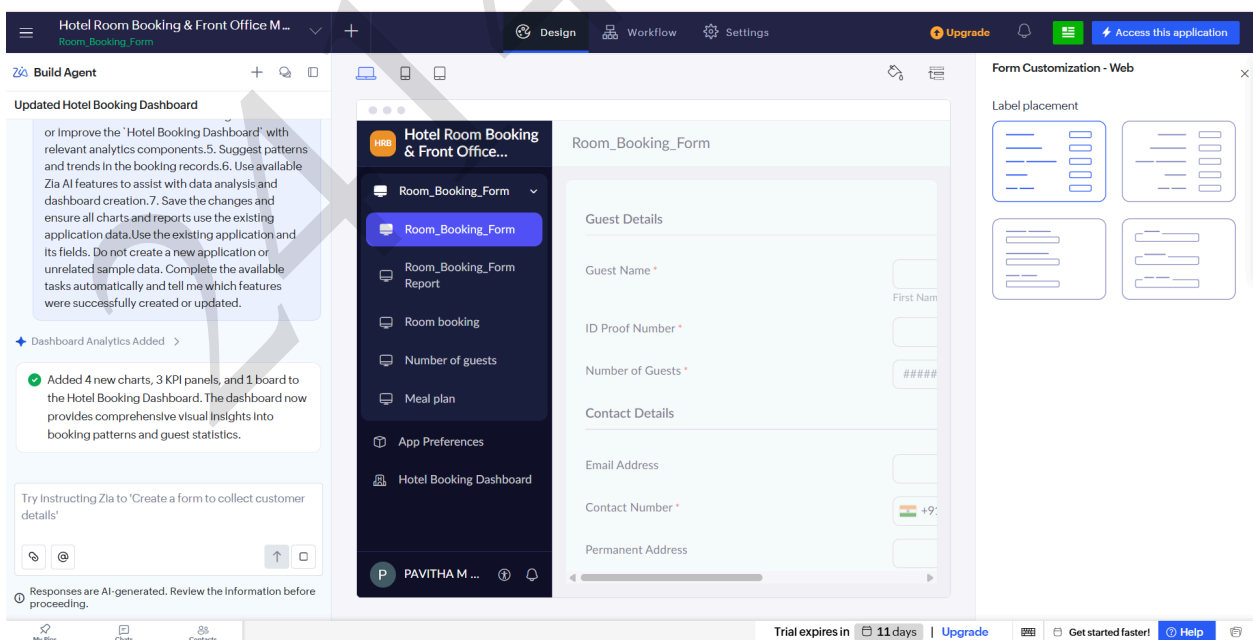
Step 3: Analyze Booking Data

Zia was prompted to analyze the existing **Room_Booking_Form** and **Room_Booking_Report** data, including room types, number of guests, and check-in dates.



Step 4: Generate Insights

Zia was asked to identify useful patterns and trends in the booking records to support hotel booking management.

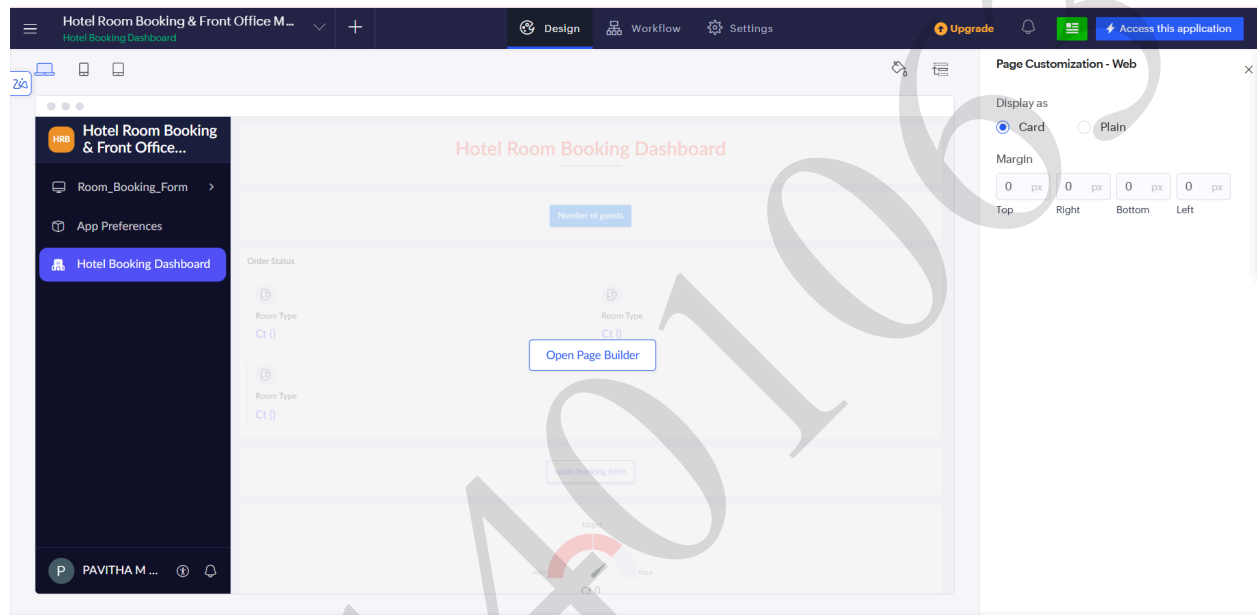


Step 5: Create Visualizations

Zia was prompted to generate suitable charts and visualizations to summarize the booking data and make it easier to understand.

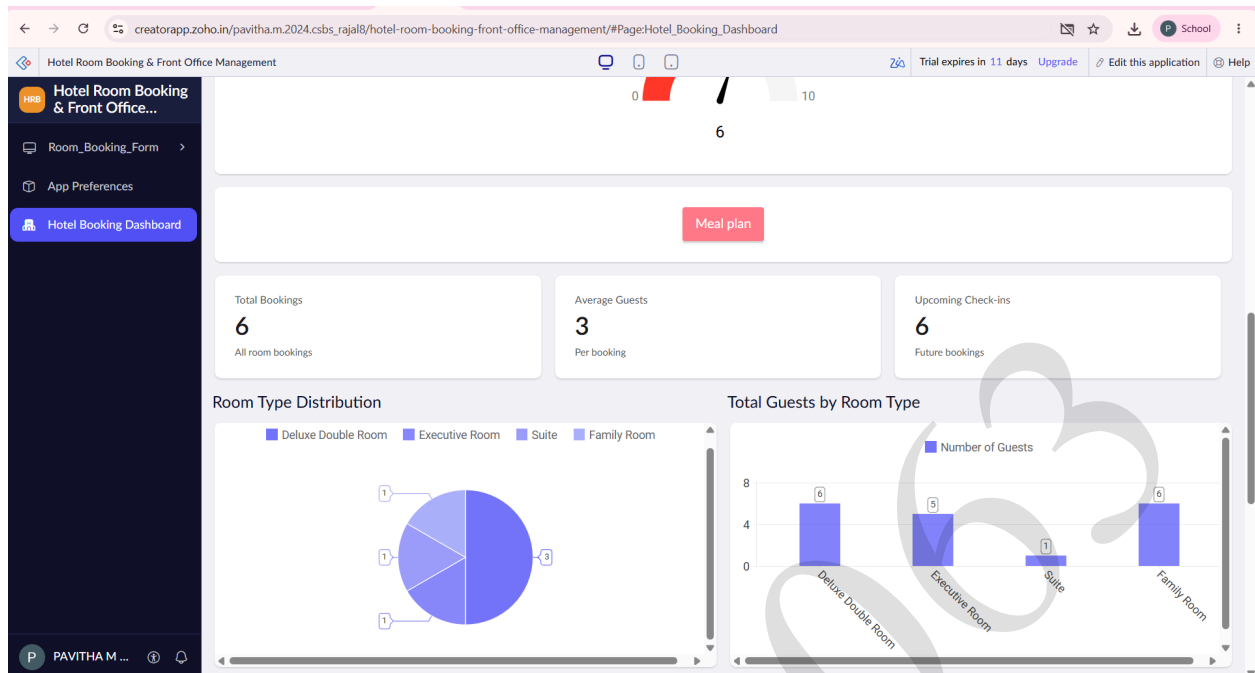
Step 6: Improve the Dashboard

The existing **Hotel Booking Dashboard** was selected for improvement. Zia was asked to suggest or create relevant analytics components using the available application data.



Step 7: Review the Results

The generated insights, charts, and dashboard components were reviewed to check whether they represented the existing booking data correctly.



Final Result

The AI-assisted features and built-in analytics capabilities of Zia in Zoho Creator were explored using the Hotel Room Booking & Front Office Management application. Existing booking data was used to investigate insights, visualizations, and dashboard improvements.

The experiment demonstrated how AI-assisted analysis and visual reporting can help users understand booking information, identify useful patterns, and support data-driven decision-making in hotel management.